

She didn't bring her notebook today.
That's her version of rebellion now – not documenting, not performing the script.

She just sat, arms crossed, breathing shallow.

I didn't say anything. Neither did she.

At the end she said, "You know, I don't think you care."

I replied, "Maybe not about what you think I do."

She frowned.

People like her want the monster to either be real or be gone.
They don't know what to do with something in between.

So I give her both. Just enough care to keep her coming back.
Just enough coldness to keep her confused.

She won't leave.
And if she does, she'll blame herself.

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